are also certain limitations to decision-making and decision outcome. The limitations can arise from outside the decisional system and limitations arising from the nature and functioning of the decisional system.

Criticisms

Though the decision-making approach became a handy tool to study foreign policy processes, it has been criticized on several grounds. Scholars, though they acknowledge the positive contribution of this approach, at the same time contend that this approach is partial. Decision-making approach is impressive and is an innovation over the traditional power-centric approaches but it has failed to provide a comprehensive study of international relations. Again, it itself suffers from state-centrism by putting more emphasis on states as actors. It neglects objective realities. It also focusses more on the motives and actions of the decision-makers and completely ignores the impact of other factors on international politics. It helps understand the foreign policy processes and importance of the decision-makers in that respect but, in doing so, it focusses more on images and perceptions rather than on ground realities. This approach also disregards the importance of norms and values in national and international politics. Further, there are no uniform methods or techniques of analyzing the decision-making process. Nevertheless, this theory is an improvement upon the institutional approaches as it tried to provide an explanation of the behavioural pattern of the states under different circumstances.